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SARAH ANN LUNT

Born August 11, 1858, Manti, Utah

Died December 27, 1921, Pacheco, Mexico

Married January 16, 1878, St. George Temple

"It doesn't hurt to pinch when you don't
have to, but it sure hurts when it is a must"

(Photograph obtained from Sarah L. McGuire, Silver City, New Mexico)



CHAPTER XXV

THE MOVE TO MEXICO BY WAY OF ARIZONA

1887 – 1889

The legislation enacted by Congress against the practice of plural marriage resulted in the prosecution and imprisonment of scores of individuals who were practicing polygamy. Many who had not yet come to trial or imprisonment were in constant hiding in order to escape the clutches of laws deemed by them to be unconstitutional. Husbands were separated from wives and, in many instances, children from their parents. Homes that had known nothing but contentment and peace were broken up. Terror reigned throughout the Great Basin.

Henry Lunt and his companions who had been staying on the mountain decided to come home in the spring when the planting needed to be done. They used every means at their disposal to escape the "Feds," as their pursuers were called. Sarah Ann's son, Parley, wrote the following concerning the problem:

The officers used to come to Cedar City on the stage and stay at the Lunt Hotel and would try to pick up people that were living in plural marriage. One of the officers came while Father [Henry] was eating his supper. He opened the door just a little and gave Father a sign to get out before the other officers could

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see him. Father picked up a piece of pie and ran to Webster's, a neighbor, to warn him that the officers were there.¹

President John Taylor died July 25, 1887. Taylor had done much to hold the Saints together during the polygamy persecutions. Wilford Woodruff was his successor. Woodruff, like Taylor, was an early associate of the Prophet Joseph Smith and was likewise a bulwark of strength. President Woodruff worked diligently to restore harmony with the civil government. He also worked hard to bring the Church out of its financial difficulties, since much of the Church property was taken over by the government. This state of affairs induced John Taylor and George Q. Cannon of the First Presidency of the Church to contact Stake President Layton of an Arizona Stake suggesting that an effort be made to obtain "a place of refuge under a foreign government to which our people can flee."²

Early in 1885, Erastus Snow and President Taylor, along with Francis M. Lyman, Moses Thatcher, and John Sharp, took a trip to Colorado, Arizona, and Mexico. Their trip took them to the Salt River settlements in Mesa, Arizona. They went on into Mexico in the vicinity of Corralitos, Chihuahua, where arrangements had already been made with the Mexican government to acquire some property. They were given an option of thirty days to buy a large tract of land on which to build this place of refuge. Several of the brethren were left to put in crops and further explore the country. Moses Thatcher and Christopher Layton were detailed to go back to Salt Lake City and there obtain money to pay for the land.³ Many of the L.D.S. polygamist families chose to move to Mexico rather than be separated, and to escape the father of the family being captured and put in prison.

Apostle Erastus Snow visited Cedar City during the fall of 1887 where he stayed at the Lunt Hotel. While there, he showed a great concern for the Lunts. Broughton wrote the following:

Apostle Erastus Snow said to Mother, 'Sarah, it is your job to take your husband and go to Old Mexico where you can acquire land as a place of

refuge. We have talked to President Porfirio Diaz and he is willing to allow us to live our religion there. We can build up and beautify the country. Diaz says his people are in need of being taught a better way of living and doing things. Other people are there and two settlements are already established, Colonia Diaz and Colonia Juarez.' In response, Mother said, 'Brother Snow, do you know what you are asking of me? This hotel is the only means of support to the entire family. Brother Lunt is blind and I am needed by the family to help run the hotel. We have no means, and my oldest son is only eight years old.' He said, 'Sister Lunt, I feel it is the will of God that you should go, and the Lord will open the way if you will but obey.' Mother prayed and fasted and thought the thing over; she was strong willed and did not act until she knew it was right.

On November 26, 1887, our family left at night for Arizona. There were no farewells. Only the most trusted friends knew we had gone. Our party consisted of Father [age 63], Mother [age 29], Edgerton [age 8], Broughton [age 6], Parley [age 4], and Edward [age 2]. We took the southern route by way of 'Dixie.' We went through Toquerville, on to Virgin City and up a canyon called North Creek where a family by the name of Sanders lived. It was great grape country. I will never forget the pickled grapes put down in barrels. I have never seen any since like them.

We found lodging in a two-room log house which had been used by campers as an old junk house. One of mother's first discoveries there was that all we children were lousy. I well remember the days of scrubbing and cleaning until the pests were exterminated. Then came the measles. The remedy was 'Sheep Berry Tea.' It did all that any highly advertised, patented medicine could do. It cured the

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measles. While there, we boys learned how to make slat quail traps. Father bought us a sack of wheat for bait, and we climbed the sunny hillsides and found bare spots where the snow had melted off, made a trail of wheat leading to the trap, then waited for the catch. How happy we were one morning to find we had caught thirteen quail in one trap. How well I remember the quail pie that night.

When the weather permitted, we moved on. We arrived in February 1888 at Moccasin Springs, Arizona, where we stayed at a stock ranch operated by Christopher Heaton. My brother, Heaton, was born there March 7, 1888 [This was Sarah's fifth child and Henry's twenty-third]. When he was three weeks old, we journeyed on, going by way of Kanab over the Buckskin Mountains to House Rock. My half-brother, Oscar [age 17], joined us at Pipe Springs and brought the old white-topped family buggy. We loaded the bedding and provisions and needed camp equipment in the buggy where Mother and the children rode therein. The heavier goods were loaded on the big wagon. On acquiring the new, fresh team and hitching them to the buggy, Mother thought it safer to ride on the heavy wagon. But, even then, when going down a steep rocky hill, Mother was thrown from the wagon with the baby. In trying to protect the baby from injury during the fall, the heavy wagon ran over her ankle and hurt it severely. Father had her sit on a stone and he administered to her. She recovered sufficiently to continue the journey, although she remained lame for months.

Mother had a natural horror of crossing the Colorado River at Lee's Ferry. Just a short time before we crossed, a man was drowned while attempting to cross. We had to cross at the ferry, and it necessitated going over 'Lee's Backbone,' a very

dangerous steep mountain. I will never forget, as we started down the ridge with steep canyons on both the north and the south sides. Oscar fell from the wagon and lodged on the "tugs" of the team on his back. The brake came off and the horses were unable to control the wagon. No matter which way it went, it meant certain destruction. Luckily, Oscar regained control and all was well. On the river, men had to hold the wagon from tipping into the water.

From the Colorado to the Little Colorado is a barren waste with but little water. Most of what water was obtained had lodged to the holes of the rocks and had been there for months. Sheep had also watered at these holes, and the liquid was very yellow and brackish. It always had to be boiled, and some substitute flavoring added, to be used at all. On reaching the Little Colorado we had a new experience. The horses were famished and very thirsty and, seeing water, plunged into it and sank deep in quicksand. After a great deal of exertion we finally got them out. We then traveled up the river to Winslow, Holbrook and Joseph City, Arizona. We then went on to Snowflake and Pinedale where we stayed that summer and rented six acres of land.

Brothers Freeman and Flake let us milk a few of their range cows. Mother did the milking, while the boys herded the cows and calves. The Apache Indians were not under thorough control and often broke off the reservation. We remained in Pinedale at Fish's Ranch the winter of 1888 and I went to school at Pinedale, a mile away. Joseph Smith of Snowflake was the teacher. He lived at the Fish Ranch also. Many a morning I held to one fork of his swallow-tailed cow to keep from being lost in the snow, as we trudged on our way to school.

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The following was taken from the writings of Joseph Fish:

Brother Lunt had just arrived (spring of 1888) from Utah, he having come out to avoid the prosecutions for polygamy, and we were going up to get him located for the time being. He was going by the name of 'John Cope.' Meeting was held on the 6th [June] at which James Lewis, Joseph Fish, Henry Lunt and President Smith spoke. In the evening a meeting was held at my house. We managed to get Brother Lunt quite comfortably located. I let him have one of my houses to live in. I also let him have six acres of land to cultivate for the season. He also had the use of my plows, corrals, etc. Bishop Peterson let him have some land. He [Henry] was not able to do much in the line of farming, but he had several boys that were large enough to do considerable. He thought this was a lonesome place and out of this world. It was certainly in the forest region and probably looked lonesome to one that had never lived in such a place. It was not more than a ranch, and one could not expect to have city conveniences in such a place. We, however, did the best we could for him.⁴

After Henry and Sarah left Cedar City with their family, Mary Ann and Ellen continued to manage the Lunt Hotel and Stage Stop. They were assisted by some of the children. Annie's family lived in a home across the street from the Lunt Hotel, but they were involved in the running of the family affairs. Mary Ann had four children at home who were not yet married. William (Willie), the only boy not married, helped with the chores and kept things in repair while the girls, Florence, Violet and Maude, worked as telegraph operators and helped with other household duties. Randle (Mary Ann's fourth child) and his wife, Catherine, took a major roll in the management of the Hotel; in fact, all of the children, at one time or another, took their turn at helping to keep the hotel operating. Mary Ann's oldest child,

Henrietta wrote about working as a telegraph operator, but she was married and had four children before Henry and Sarah Ann left. Her husband, Lehi W. Jones, was called on a mission to the Southern States in January of 1888, shortly after the Lunts left for Mexico.

Apostle Erastus Snow, who was 69 years old, died in Salt Lake City of uremic poisoning May 27, 1888, six months after the Lunts left for Mexico. Snow was instrumental in building up and promoting the colonies in Mexico, and he advised the Lunts to go there.⁵ Henry and his family stopped in Pinedale, Arizona and he wrote the following letter to Lehi from there on July 2, 1888:

My dear Brother Lehi: News of the 7th came safely to hand some time ago and am always pleased to hear from you and continually pray that you may be preserved in good health and from mob violence. This mission will give you valuable experience and better prepare you for others, and will cause you to more fully appreciate the value of the Gospel and the associations of the Saints and your sweet mountain home than you, otherwise, possibly could. It is one of the best things in the world for our young men to go on a mission to preach the Gospel abroad in the nations, for they realize many things that they cannot at home. Indeed, it is necessary for us all to have a certain amount of experience. Even in my case, I feel that it will all be for my good and that of my family. We need not expect to have all sweet and no bitter in this life, which is but short at the longest.

You would be surprised, and sorry too, to hear of the death of Apostle E. Snow and others of our old friends in Cedar that have passed away in the short time since you have been away. It is time for our young men to begin to think what they are about, for who else can we look to but our sons to help bear off this Kingdom, but the sons of the old veterans of this Church. The late dedication of the Manti Temple is

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another grand occasion, and victory for the L.D. Saints, and it fills every faithful member of the church with joy and gladness and makes us feel to shout, 'Glory Hallelujah' to God & the Lamb.

Aunt Ellen writes me that Henrietta has got another fine daughter, and that is another grand occasion--what say you? You see, business goes on all right and prosperous if you are from home. Our Willie writes me, enclosed in Aunt Ellen's, that Thomas Taylor told him that he had as good [as] sold the iron & coal mines, and was going to build a big store on his lot in Cedar. I think he would manifest a deal more good sense if he would put up a woolen factory.

Thank God we are all pretty well in health, although I am somewhat afflicted with rheumatism in my right hip. The weather is very warm and dry. We are still living here in the timber in an old log cabin, and the prospect to make a home here is not very flattering, though I would sooner try it here, without any water is the case--only well water, than in South Carolina [where Lehi was on his mission].

Sarah joins me in kindest love to you. Write again. I expect to go tomorrow to Snowflake and try and enjoy myself with an old friend, Jesse N. Smith, on the celebration of the glorious fourth of July. J. Cope

Henry took the name of "John Cope" while in exile to avoid being tracked by the Federal officers. His older sister in England, Mary Ann, married a man named John Cope, so this name came to mind when Henry needed a new identity.

Mary Ann wrote a letter to Lehi telling of the arrival of his new baby daughter, Ann, who was born June 15, 1888. Mary Ann and Lehi's mother were with Henrietta during the night when the baby was born, and Mary Ann describes the event to Lehi. The following are excerpts from this letter:

Florence left on the stage this a.m. for St. George for a few days visit. Thought an out would be beneficial, as she has worked pretty hard. Aunt Ellen has been quite sick since in the middle of the night so I had to come home [from being with Henrietta] as there were only Violet and Maude to look after things [Violet was 14 and Maude was 12 years old]. But Henrietta is in good hands, your mother and Cora being there.

Two men are here from Kansas buying up sheep to take out to Nebraska. They will take about thirty-five hundred from here; and, from telegrams they have sent to different places in Utah, I guess they will have many more.

You will likely have heard of Brother Webster's arrest by this time. The Deputies drove into town all unawares and McGeary was in the house before anyone saw or heard him. Brother Webster was sitting in his accustomed place, so they had everything right to their hand. Started to the Reef [Silver Reef] with him where he was to have a hearing before Commissioner Jordon at ten today. Have not heard the result yet. Ain't it too bad, after eluding them so long, that he should have to go at last, but it seems either the folks must leave the country or go to the pen. [Francis Webster stayed on the mountain with Henry during the preceding winter.]

We are all well as a family and getting along in our financial matters pretty well. Had to buy a team, cost 165 dollars, and sent means to our exiles [Henry and family in Mexico]. It also takes a good deal to keep up the house, but we are thankful to be able to help ourselves and the rest of the family.

The following entry was made in the Cedar City ward records concerning Henry's release as Bishop and his November departure:

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This year [1888] Bishop Lunt removed to Mexico and, at a special meeting held at Cedar City on Friday, December 21, 1888, attended by Apostle John W. Taylor, Wm. Henry Corry was unanimously sustained as Bishop of Cedar City with Uriah Treharne Jones as First and John R. Chappin as Second Counselor. Myron D. Higbee was chosen as Ward Clerk. In the Second District Court at Beaver, December 22, 1888, Francis Webster of Cedar City was sentenced by Judge Boreman to six months imprisonment in the Utah Penitentiary for unlawful cohabitation.⁶

Henry and Sarah and their little family stayed in Pinedale for nearly a year and a half. It was a lonely place and Henry was never very happy with the conditions there. They were living in someone else's house, farming someone else's property, and borrowing even the machinery to do what farming they did. Apparently they were able to make a meager living, but they had to be continually supplemented with money and necessary items from home.

Joseph Fish, the man who supplied a place for Henry to live and some acreage for him to farm, worked at a co-op store as well as taught school. He wrote in his account that the summer of 1889 was very dry and the sheep were overgrazing the land. He related that he spent the 4th of July 1889 in Holbrook much as other holidays--the cowboys getting drunk. He wrote: "I spent the day as I did others, in the store at work. And thus the days passed on with a sameness. To me it was rather lonesome, for Holbrook was a lonesome place for a Mormon at that date."

Henry was getting anxious to do something about their situation and decided to make a trip to Mexico to investigate the conditions there. Thomas Amos, Henry and Ann Gower Lunt's son, wrote the following:

Father, weary from the constant uneasiness he had experienced for so long, made a hasty trip down to

Colonia Juarez in the summer [late spring] of 1889 to see just what the outlook was on making a new home. He found things there much to his liking. He met a number of former acquaintances and old friends who had located in the sunny climate, and he decided to join them in this new venture.⁷

On the 22 of May, Joseph Fish wrote in his journal: "Brother Henry Lunt (known here as John Cope) came in last night from Mexico. He had been down there to look over the country and if it suited him he was going to move there. He went on up home on the buckboard."⁸

Henry wrote a letter to his daughter, Eva, about the first of June 1889. The following is the second page which was all that was available:

If I should be advised to return to Utah, the joy and anticipation of seeing you all again would drive away all fears of bonds and imprisonments. I have not answered Mother's [Mary Ann's] last letter yet, but you must let her read this. I think Aunt Ellen and Henry W. will let you read the letters I wrote to them if you ask them. I am pleased to learn of the little boys making such good progress in their book learning [Henrietta and Lehi Jones's sons--Willard, Kumen and Henry, and Ellen Eva and Thomas Jed Jones's boys--Lamoni and Randall]. Tell them all--Willard, Monie, Kumen, Randall and Henry--that Grandpa has not forgotten them. Bless their little innocent hearts, how I would like to see them all together with Edgie, Broughton, Parley, and Edward [Sarah's sons]. What a jollification they would have, to be sure!

Our little baby, Heaton, is not quite 15 months old, but he is a sharper on his feet, eyes black as coal and very much like your brother Henry's children. Julia Fish has a little boy the same age, but Heaton is about a head taller. He doesn't talk yet, but he makes some very significant

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motions when he wants anything. Edgerton is living with Brother Joseph Smith at Snowflake doing chores and going to school. The children all seem to be growing, but Parley, and I can't see much difference in him, but his mother says she knows he is growing as his pants get too short. He is very thin in flesh, more so I think than ever.

Sarah is very thin and there is no fear of me having the gout through high living. I am 30 pounds less in weight than when I left England last. I am satisfied of one thing, and that is that our settlements in Mexico are far ahead of the settlements in Utah to raise the youth of Zion, in as the morals and examples are much better. I was told when there that there was not one person in Juarez that smoked and no profanity whatever, and the best of schools and meetings. Sarah joins me in dearest love to you both and children and all the family connection, especially remembering our beloved Sister Jones and Brother and Sister Samuel Leigh and their connection, and then, lastly but not the least, every one of my dear old friends. Wino Adious (Good day or God be with you) from your affectionate Father, Henry Lunt

(In the border) I correspond with Lehi quite regularly and he seems to be feeling well and no doubt his mission will be of great benefit to him. I am very sorry to hear by the brethren that Brother [C. J.] Arthur was sentenced to the full extent of the law [one of the men who spent the winter on the mountain with Henry. He was found guilty and sentenced May 16, 1889 at Beaver]. The new Judge Anderson is not any better than his predecessor. I am afraid the oppression by our enemies will grow much worse before we have more liberty in Utah than there is now, as I don't think they will be satisfied until every Mormon is disenfranchised and they get the civil government in their hands. The Supreme Court of the U.S. has done one good thing for us in the decision in the Nielson Case. If they now would render a decision in the

church suit case that the Edmunds-Tucker Law was unconstitutional, you would, with God's blessing, soon see me in old Cedar, but they dare not do it. We must 'do what is right and let the consequence follow.' I enclose the last letter I received from Lehi for Henrietta to read.

Henry was rather pleased with what he saw when he made the trip to Mexico to investigate the colonies. The capitol colony, Colonia Juarez, was a beautiful village comparable to any in New England. There was every evidence of thrift, cleanliness, industry, comfort, and good management. As Henry mentioned in the preceding letter, there were no saloons, tobacco shops, jails, nor houses of ill-fame in the colony. The property was owned by Mormons, and the internal affairs of the several settlements were under the direction of the Church. There were a gristmill, a furniture factory, and other industries in that city. There was an academy with five teachers and 400 pupils.

Although most of the Mormon settlers who came to Mexico in 1889 were poor people, no difficulty or hardship was great enough to appall them or drive them back. They made ditches, turned the water of the river upon their lands, planted fruit trees, laid out gardens, tended their flocks, and plenty came to support and sustain them. In a single "Stake," comprising the colonies or wards of Colonia Juarez, Colonia Diaz, Dublan, Oaxaca, Pacheco, Garcia, and Chuichupi, the Mormons numbered 2,523 persons and 477 families. They had practically nothing but their physical strength and religious enthusiasm. Around them were high mountains, capped with snow, dark canyons, where wild beasts made their lairs, and a narrow arid valley barren of vegetation, except grama grass and cottonwood trees. Apache Indians lurked in the hills, drove away their herds, and sometimes attacked the settlements. But still the Mormons prospered.⁹

Henry made the decision to take his families to Mexico where they could be more independent and obtain property of their own. He felt, with the Lord's help, that they could even prosper there. He decided to send for Annie, his second wife, and those of her family that were not married. They would need the help of the older children in settling in this new country. He also wanted the family to be

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together. It had not been a desirable situation to be away from those in Cedar City. When he returned to Pinedale he got in touch at once with Henry W. to make the necessary preparations to begin the move of those family members in Cedar City who would be able to leave. Henry W. was Henry's oldest son who had assumed the management of the family affairs in Cedar City during his absence. Thomas Amos Lunt wrote the following in his history:

It was late in life for father to undertake such a move. He was in his 65th year. Aunt Sarah's boys were too young to render much help in the heavy work of home building. Mother [Ann Gower Lunt] was, therefore, asked to go. Although she had a good home, besides other valuable property, and the three oldest children were already married, she promptly complied with the request. She was in a position to care for herself and children very well had she remained in Cedar. All these developments were withheld from us children; we weren't told a thing about it until shortly before we were to leave Cedar.

In the summer of 1889, Henry W. and William [Mary Ann's boys who were 26 and 22 years old], taking Aunt Ellen along, made a hurried trip to Lee's Ferry on the Colorado River, where they met Father. Here details were worked out regarding the big march which was soon to start. Aunt Ellen accompanied Father back to Pinedale while the two boys beat a hasty retreat to Cedar.

Anna Gower Lunt, age 46, left Cedar City early on Sunday morning, September 1, 1889, along with her children, George (age 15), Tom (age 11), Ellen (age 8), and Rachel (age 6). They reluctantly left their married sisters with their husbands and families, Rose (age 21) in Cedar and Jane and Jemima in Salt Lake. Thomas wrote:

Henry W. and George A., accompanied by Joe Bryant, had left two hours earlier with the four-horse outfit in order to climb the mountain in the cool of the day. Will

took the rest of us in the family buggy. We overtook the wagon near Green's Lake, part way up the mountain. George was perched upon a rock taking a last look at our native town. I well remember how he cursed all nature 'black and blue' at the thought of going down to 'that land of savages and rattlesnakes.' Henry W. told me years later that he would never forget the black look George gave him as they parted at Navajo Lake camp ground.

We arrived at Walt's Flat about the middle of the afternoon. Aunt Mary Ann and her two youngest girls [Violet and Maude] were ranching there. We remained there the rest of the day while the boys attended to some horseshoeing and other fixing up of the outfit. Lehi and Jed Jones and their wives [Henrietta and Eva--Mary Ann's oldest daughters] came from their ranch at Miner's Peak to tell us goodbye.

Monday morning we were off to a good start, going by way of Three Creeks and Navajo Lake, at which point Henry W. and Joe Bryant bade us goodbye and turned back. We nooned just below Walker's ranch east of Three Creeks. We all walked up to the house, which was some distance off the road, to tell our neighbors, of long years standing, goodbye.

This was a difficult trip to make. Thomas tells of his parting with his good friend, Arch Walker, and how reluctant he was to leave. The story continues:

Will W. accompanied us to Lee's Ferry on the Colorado River. We had a 3 1/4 Mitchell Wagon, drawn by four horses. Besides this, we had a saddle pony that I usually rode and a little chestnut sorrel mare we called 'Jimmy' which was very lazy. Henry had acquired him on a trade. He gave a little Indian pony, a two-wheeled-one-horse cart, a half-grown pig, a bushel of oats and fifty cents to Jimmy Dutton for the 'nag.' Hence the name.

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When the group left Navajo Lake they traveled to Duck Creek, past the "Sinks," and followed a country road that led down the Left Fork of Long Valley just above Glendale. They cut across the head of Kanab Creek and went on to the tiny settlement of Johnson. They waited there for two or three days for a man named Cheeney who was supposed to travel with them to Pinedale. The man failed to show up so they continued on over the Buckskin Mountains and reached Lee's Ferry four days later. They expected to meet Oscar, Annie's oldest son who was 19 years old, there but he also failed to appear. They waited at Lee's Ferry for several days and finally went on to the "Moaby" ranch, accompanied by Warren Johnson, the ferry operator. He went by horseback. Thomas wrote:

I must mention that our stay at the ferry was pleasant. They had an abundance of fruit, just ripe, and they were very liberal with it. Nor did we slight the opportunity. One day Mrs. Johnson was coming down the pathway that led by our wagon carrying a large bread pan filled with grapes. Stopping just opposite our camp and setting the pan down, she handed me the largest bunch of grapes I have ever yet seen. As I held them up, they reached from my waistline to the ground. And they were just as delicious to the taste as they were sparkling to the eye. We were awed by the roar of the rapids of the muddy stream, and the skill of the oarsmen in handling the big flat boat was an eyeful to us. George and I made several trips on the ferry as travelers were being taken across. Thus, our time was well taken up.

Will saw us safely over Lee's Backbone and camped with us at the foot of the big rugged hill before starting on his homeward trek. There being no grass for the horses, we were obliged to tie up some large bundles of alfalfa which the boys packed on the saddle horses. Ellen and Rachel were each snugly placed between the bundles of the hay astride the horses. Mother and George walked from the boat landing up the rough hill. Will drove the

team and I brought up the rear on my pony. The leaders were driven loose. Will preferred to trust old "Dick" and "Frank" [the horses] to handle the wagon over the dangerous Backbone. Two trips were required to see our outfit over the river. Will told us goodbye next morning. He had brought his horse, 'Doby,' along to make the return trip to Cedar. We turned our faces southward. It was not long before Mr. Johnson caught up with us. He was a very kindly dispositioned man and we enjoyed his company exceedingly.

At the Moaby ranch we were obliged to await Oscar's coming, for ahead of us stretched a wild no-man's land, much infested with Navajo Indians of an unfriendly nature. Then too, for miles the road was so dim, having been washed out by recent floods, making it difficult to follow. The delay here, like our wait at the ferry, we found much to our liking. The Fautz family, owners of the ranch, were very hospitable. They too had lots of fruit, especially melons. The day of our arrival, George offered a child a nickel on a melon trade. The boy asked how many melons he wanted for the nickel. George gasped for his breath and then said that one would do.

After waiting for ten days, Oscar finally arrived. He brought with him a team and a light spring wagon. He was accompanied by one, Jeff Adams. We had become acquainted at the ranch and were not very enthusiastic about leaving. The old yellow mare we called 'Squaw' absolutely refused to go. After watching the boys resort to every means to force her to obey orders, with no favorable results, Mr. Fautz said, 'Take her down to where the bay mare is staked. Leave her there and take the bay.' The trade was made and we were soon on our way. Within a day or two we reached the Little Colorado River which we followed in a general way until we reached Woodruff [in Arizona]. At the Moot Mackelprang ranch, near Portersville, we took another

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breathing spell. The outfit that Oscar had brought to meet us in belonged to Mackelprang. When we had been here but two days, father came to meet us. I had to cry, partly through joy of meeting him after his long absence from us, and partly because I noticed how careworn he looked. We lost no time from this point on to Pinedale, camping one night at Woodruff and the next at Snowflake. Our final day's drive was somewhat shorter.

When [we were] a short distance from Holbrook we passed some Mexican freighters loaded for Camp Apache. They were driving oxen.

This was somewhat of a novelty to see oxen again because most everyone in Cedar City was now using horses. They found, however, that oxen were the main 'draught' animal in Mexico. The natives used them almost exclusively, and the American colonists also used them in logging camps. The family was quite upset about their father being called 'John Cope.' This meant that they too would have to use Cope as their last name. They found that there were several families from Parowan living in the neighborhood, and they had learned to call Henry by his assumed name. Thomas wrote:

There seemed to be so much here to do in preparation for our onward march that it was very late in autumn before we could get away. During this break in our journey, I spent much of my time herding cows. Ege, Broughton, Parley, and I took a day at a time in pairs carrying our drinking water in a can, as there was no running water. All our horses, plus about 30 head of milk cows and their calves, had to be watered daily at the well. Imagine if you can such a chore--no pump, just arm strength with a rope and a three-gallon bucket. The Apache Indians, many of them on leave of absence from their reservations, were in the neighborhood gathering pinenuts. They came to our well every day for water. Very frequently they came galloping at top speed,

accenting their savage appearance with unearthly yells. Having heard bloodcurdling tales of their raids on the whites, these wayward children of Father Lehi didn't look at all good to me. One day while on herd duty, Broughton and I were hailed by an old 'Mike' [an Indian] who was accompanied by several squaws. They wanted a drink from our can which we freely gave them, fearing to do otherwise. On emptying the can, he tied it on his saddle and rode off. I really believe he understood we had given him the can. We were so frightened we offered no objections, feeling ourselves lucky to get off with our lives. We told the folks at home about it and Aunt Sarah watched for the old 'longhair' the next morning at the well. The tongue lashing he got, I'll wager, stayed with him as long as life itself! He hotfooted it back to his camp and the can was returned on the double quick.

Father made a hurried trip to Holbrook the last thing to take Aunt Ellen to the railroad where she boarded the train for Milford and on to Cedar. She remained in Cedar for upwards of two years before finally joining us in Mexico. On leaving Pinedale, Father adopted as our evening hymn, *Lord We Come Before Thee Now*. We usually sang it around our campfire before family prayer. We drove from Pinedale, 18 head of cows and heifers and a young bull. Aunt Sarah also took a bunch of chickens. The cattle driving fell to Edg and me. We each had a pony and a saddle.

The Lunt family was joined by another family of questionable character. This family, named Adams, claimed to be on their way to Mexico but were delayed when they were caught in a snow storm, as it was getting late into the fall. The family seemed to be in a hurry to leave, only staying with the company three days. They left at daybreak one morning and the Lunts found that one of their own horses was missing. The boys knew that Adams had taken the animal. In addition to this problem, the boys had to go back along the trail to find a barrel

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that had been scrubbed off one of the horses as it went by a tree. Later they went back again for the chickens that had jumped out of their box when the door jolted open. They recovered all except one that an old Indian had beat them to. Thomas wrote:

Having been thrown short by the loss of our best work horse, we had to put one of the saddle animals to work. This threw the cattle drivers short and we had to take it turn about, traveling afoot and horseback, until we reached the Gila Valley. At Pima we stopped for two weeks and we kids went to school in the daytime while, at night, a free-for-all sweet potato roast was indulged in. Most of us had never heard of sweet potatoes before.

Father had a strong notion to settle in Pima. There were some fine opportunities for making homes there. But, three other families came along on their way to the colonies and Father decided to go with them. Christopher Heaton was among the newcomers and, upon learning that we needed a work horse, he came to our rescue. So, we were fixed once again so we didn't have to walk. A camp organization was affected and John Jacob Walser from Payson was named captain of the company. Warner Porter and family and his newly married son and wife, all from Orderville, also joined us. There were now 51 people, 12 wagons, 26 horses, 2 mules, 19 head of cattle, and a dozen chickens in our outfit. Some gay times were had around the evening campfire. Musical talent was much in evidence.

Before reaching the railroad we had difficulty in finding water for camp use. It was a long way between watering places and sometimes we had to pay as much as five cents a head to water our stock. One place in particular, we had to draw water from a 200-foot well. There was one ten-gallon keg on each end of the 400-foot rope and the men changed off, keeping the rope and kegs going as fast as possible. It seemed almost an

impossibility to supply the camp by such a slow and laborious process.

The following account of their arrival in Mexico is from Broughton's history:

We finally reached Deming, New Mexico, a railroad town [40 miles from the Mexican border]. There we stocked up on a few things we needed, as far as our meager means allowed, before crossing into Mexico. Until then we had not had a stove to cook on since we left Cedar City nor a bedstead, outside of what we had made. The only furniture we had was one red and one green chair which had been made in Utah, with rawhide for the seats. At Deming, Father bought two cast iron cook stoves, one for each of his wives. They were still using them when we left Mexico. He also bought two rockers, and a half dozen chairs. This was the sum total of the furniture we owned. We did have plenty of good homemade quilts and plenty of empty ticks which we filled with corn husks after we raised the corn. We also had three feather beds and several pillows. Until the first corn crop was harvested in Pacheco, we used pine needles or pulled wild grass to fill the bed ticks.

Upon arriving in Colonia Diaz [a few days before Christmas], we had to leave the only team of horses we had. They were old and nothing but mares could go on from there, duty free. We also had to leave one of the cows which became too weak to travel. From Juarez to Pacheco was the hard end of the journey, as the notorious San Diego Canyon had to be scaled. We managed to acquire the assistance of lumber haulers who went up empty to get lumber. We arrived on what was the townsite of Pacheco just as the sun was setting in the west. It had been previously surveyed and laid off into city lots, each lot containing one and 1/4 acres, with wide

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streets and a small alley running through the blocks both ways to avoid corrals being built on the main street. There were two small houses built on the townsite when we arrived, one owned by George Haws and the other by Alexander F. MacDonald, the latter being the surveyor. The town was built on a small mesa of about 200 acres, falling away to the south. A high mountain of 1800 feet to the west and a box canyon 100 feet deep on the east bracketed the town. The canyon was cut out of solid volcanic rock by the Piedras Verdes River which drained the beautiful Corrales Valley. The Corrales Basin was surrounded by high mountains covered with beautiful 'yellow pine' timber, and provided a living for most occupants of the town by affording lumber for telephone posts, railroad ties, mining timbers, and juniper fence posts. The lowlands afforded small fertile farms and grazing lands. The townsite proved to be a very rocky piece of ground, after the abundant grass was gone, which served as such a beautiful garment when we first arrived.

We arrived in Pacheco on January 29, 1890. The next day was a busy one. We cut logs, made cribs about two feet high, then put up a ridgepole over which we stretched our wagon covers and gathered pine needles upon which we spread our quilts for beds, making as many as four-children beds in each shelter. Late in the evening of the first day, one of John C. Naegle's sons arrived at our camp with a load of lumber he had brought from a sawmill in Cave Valley and gave it to us. We used it to make a spacious kitchen and dining room by lashing a pole between two pine trees and leaning one end of the boards against the poles and letting the other end rest on the ground. This we called the 'shanty.' George went to take some of the horses off to 'the park', a small valley at the foot of Garcia Knoll, and came home with a deer tied on behind him. He was only fifteen, and what a hero he was.

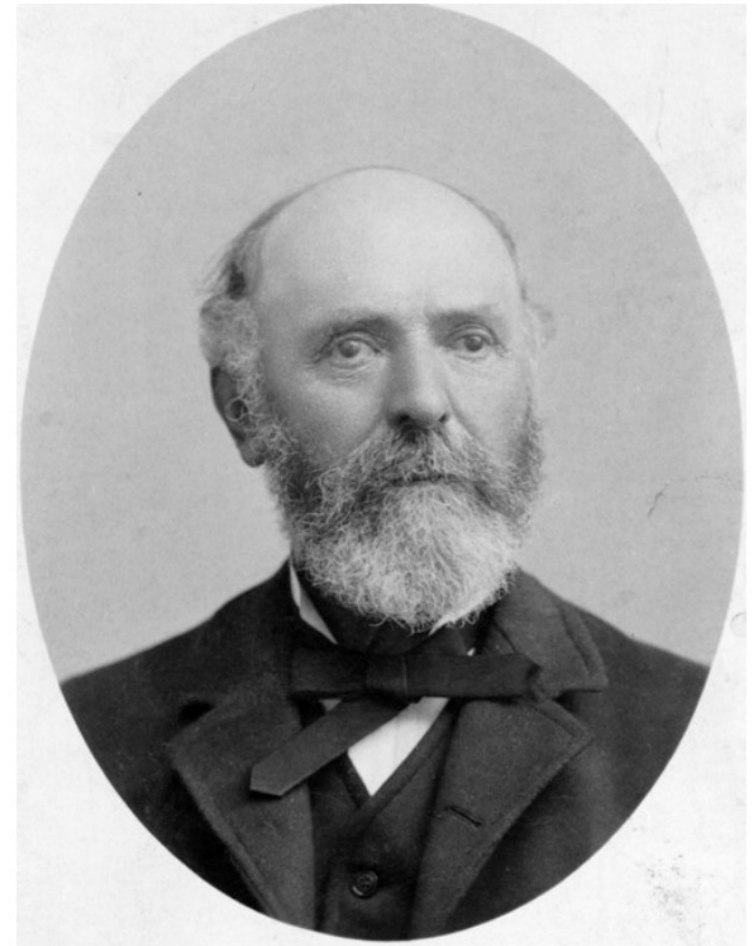
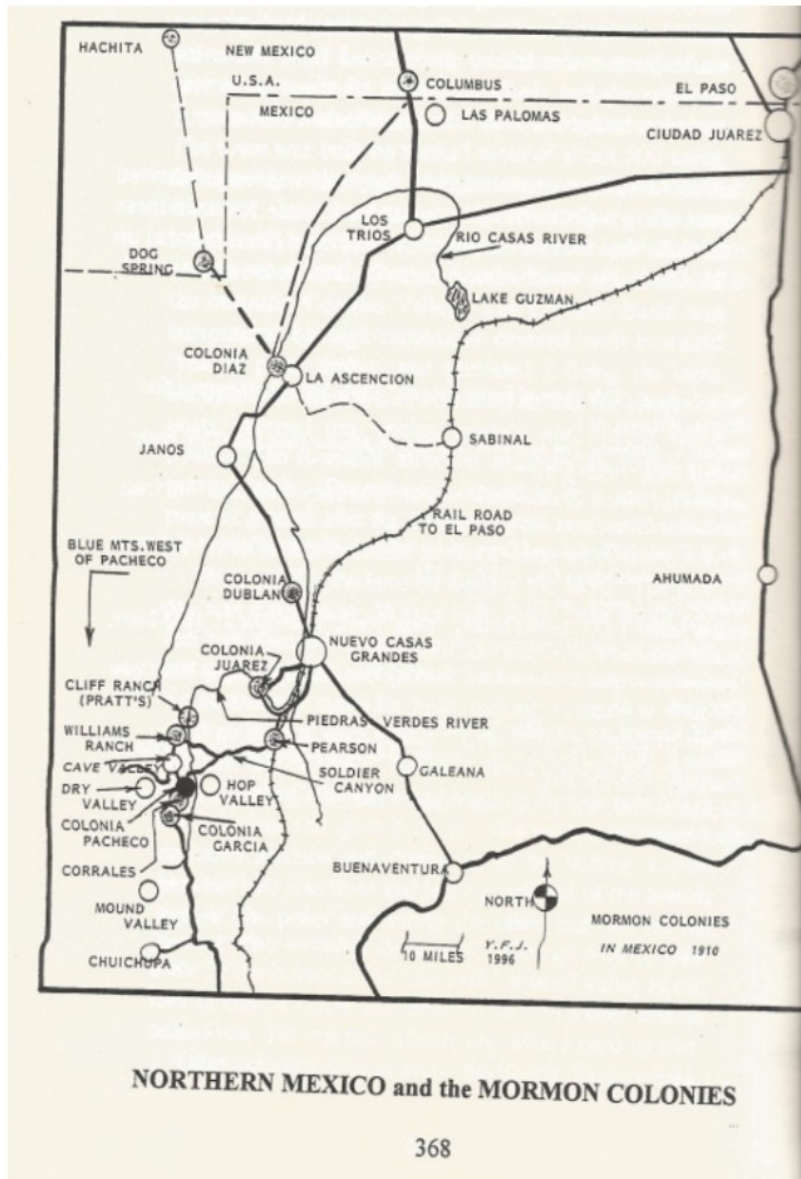
Other colonists soon arrived--the Scotts, Farnsworths,

many others. A log school and church house were quickly erected. A ditch from Water Canyon was to be dug so we could plant orchards and gardens and have water for culinary purposes. In the meantime, all of our water was carried or hauled in barrels from the streams a mile away.¹⁰

Thomas Amos Lunt wrote that "two sleeping tents were contrived by means of log walls and wagon covers for a roof. It was in these quarters that Alma first saw daylight. It happened [he was born] on April 24, 1890. He was the first baby to be born in the new town."

1. Parley L. Lunt, "Life Story of Parley L. Lunt," 1961, Sylvia L. Heywood file, Phoenix, Arizona, p. 1.
2. Thomas C. Romney, *The Mormon Colonies In Mexico*, (Salt Lake City, Utah: Deseret Book, 1938) p. 51.
3. Andrew Karl Larson, *Erastus Snow*, May 27, 1888 Entry, (Salt Lake City, Utah: University of Utah Press, 1971), p. 666.
4. John H. Krenkel, *The Life and Times of Joseph Fish, Mormon Pioneer*, (Interstate Printers and Publishing Co., 1970), p. 326.
5. Andrew Karl Larson, *op. cit.*, p. 725.
6. Andrew Jensen, *L.D.S. Journal History*, "Cedar Ward," December 21, 1888 Entry, Church Historian's Office, Salt Lake City, Utah.
7. Thomas Amos Lunt, "Thomas Lunt History," 1941, Zina Lunt Rigby File, Cedar City, Utah, p. 21.
8. John H. Krenkel, *op. cit.*, May 22, 1889 Entry.
9. William E. Berrett, *The Restored Church*, (Salt Lake City, Utah: Deseret Book Company, 1969), p. 290.
10. Broughton Lunt, "Sarah Ann Lunt History," 1946, Sylvia L. Heywood History file, Phoenix, Arizona, pp. 4-5.

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HENRY LUNT

Taken when Henry was approximately fifty-eight years old
before the family left Cedar City to go to Mexico.

Photo from York F. Jones picture file.